

RETAILMIND SUPERMARKET INC.

COMPREHENSIVE OPERATIONS & POLICY MANUAL

Version 4.2 - SaaS Corporate Edition

Effective Date: 2026-06-06

Authorized by: Board of Directors & Operations Audit Committee

This document outlines the strict guidelines, customer policies, employee code of conduct, supplier level agreements (SLAs), and shelf layout principles. Compliance with all sections is mandatory.

SECTION 1: CUSTOMER RETURN & EXCHANGE POLICY

At RetailMind Supermarket, we prioritize customer satisfaction while maintaining strict control over product returns to prevent fraud. Customers are entitled to exchange or refund items within 14 days of purchase, subject to the conditions listed below:

1.1 Perishable Items & Dairy: Perishable items, including fresh fruits, vegetables, meat, and dairy products (such as Nestle Milkpak, yogurts, and butter) can only be returned or exchanged within 24 hours of purchase. The customer must present the original printed POS receipt showing the purchase transaction. Under no circumstances will dairy products showing signs of temperature abuse (e.g. curdled milk or melted butter) be accepted for refund.

1.2 Packaged Grocery & Household Goods: Packaged groceries (like Dalda Cooking Oil, Lipton Tea, and spices) and household cleaning goods (like Surf Excel and Ariel Detergent) may be returned within 14 days. The outer packaging must be unopened, undamaged, and in resealable condition with all original seals intact. Opened packets can only be returned if there is a verified manufacturing defect (e.g., package puncture or contamination).

1.3 Refund Payment Methods: Cash purchases will be refunded in cash up to 5,000 PKR. Refunds exceeding 5,000 PKR will be issued via mobile wallet transfer or bank transfer within 3 business days. Card payments must be refunded back to the original debit/credit card used during the POS checkout. Cash refunds for card transactions are strictly prohibited.

SECTION 2: COMPETITOR PRICING & PRICE MATCH GUARANTEE

To maintain our 'Lowest Price Promise' in the local retail market, we perform weekly audits against key supermarket chains, including Metro Cash & Carry, Carrefour, and Imtiaz Super Market.

2.1 Price Matching Protocol: If a customer provides proof of a lower printed price for an identical barcode item at Metro or Imtiaz, the checkout cashier is authorized to match the price, provided the resulting retail price remains above our internal Cost Price + 2% safety margin. For example, if Dalda Cooking Oil 5L has a store retail price of 2,250 PKR and our cost price is 1,850 PKR, the cashier can match Metro's price down to 2,130 PKR, as it remains highly profitable. However, if matching drops the price below cost, the request must be escalated to the Store Manager.

2.2 Price Audit Frequency: Pricing auditors must update the competitor database every Monday by 09:00 AM. Any deviations exceeding 5% must be updated in the POS pricing controller. Special focus must be maintained on Pantry and Dairy categories (specifically Dalda Cooking Oil, Lipton Tea, and Nestle Milkpak) where local competition is aggressive.

SECTION 3: INVENTORY RISK & EXPIRES MANAGEMENT

Product wastage due to shelf expiry represents a direct loss. We implement a strict 'First-In, First-Out' (FIFO) shelf stocking rule and a dynamic markdown schedule to clear stock nearing expiry:

3.1 Expiry Warning Thresholds: Perishable dairy products (e.g., yogurt, milk, cheese) must be checked daily. Dry pantry products (e.g., cooking oil, tea) must be audited weekly. Any item with less than 10 days of shelf life remaining is classified as a 'High Expiry Risk'.

3.2 Dynamic Discount Campaigns: Products with remaining shelf life between 6 to 10 days must be discounted by 15%. Products with remaining shelf life between 3 to 5 days must be marked down by 30% or placed in a 'Buy One Get One Free' (BOGO) bundle. Perishable items with 1 day remaining must be marked down by 50% for immediate clearance.

3.3 Waste Log Registrations: Once a product reaches its official expiration date, it must be removed from the shelf immediately. It is illegal to sell expired goods. The inventory clerk must log the expired quantity into the MongoDB 'wastage_logs' database under the correct SKU and user email to claim tax deductions.

SECTION 4: SUPPLIER SERVICE LEVEL AGREEMENTS (SLAs)

Supermarket supply chains depend on prompt deliveries. We maintain strict SLAs with our primary suppliers to ensure optimal stock availability:

4.1 Unilever Pakistan SLA: Unilever supplies Surf Excel, Lipton Tea, and Lux soap. Delivery lead time is strictly 3 business days from purchase order (PO) release. To waive the standard 500 PKR delivery shipping fee, each Unilever PO must meet a minimum order value of 10,000 PKR. If a PO is below 10,000 PKR, the system should automatically suggest adding high-demand Unilever items (like Lipton Tea) to clear the limit.

4.2 Dalda Foods Ltd SLA: Dalda supplies cooking oil and ghee. Deliveries are made twice weekly: on Tuesday and Friday mornings. The PO must be submitted at least 24 hours prior to the delivery window. Dalda Foods does not enforce a minimum order value, but orders exceeding 50,000 PKR receive a 1.5% bulk wholesale discount.

4.3 Nestle Pakistan SLA: Nestle supplies Milkpak 1L, yogurts, and juices. Due to the high sales velocity of dairy, Nestle delivers daily. Orders placed before 06:00 PM are delivered the next morning by 08:00 AM. Minimum order value is 5,000 PKR.

SECTION 5: CASHIER CODE OF CONDUCT & DRAWER POLICIES

To prevent internal fraud and price manipulation, all POS operators must adhere to these security rules:

5.1 Drawer Accountability: Each cashier is assigned a unique Cashier ID and a designated cash drawer containing a starting float of 10,000 PKR. No cashier is permitted to operate under another employee's login session. All drawer cash-outs must be dual-verified by the supervisor.

5.2 Manual Price Override Limits: Cashiers are strictly forbidden from manually editing item prices at checkouts. If an item price does not match the shelf label, the cashier must call a manager. Unauthorized manual price discounts will trigger an automatic alert in our AI Auditing tool and are subject to disciplinary action.

5.3 Void Transaction Protocols: Any voided transaction exceeding 1,000 PKR requires manager approval via swipe card or physical key entry. A cashier with more than 3 unapproved voids in a single shift will be flagged for retraining.

SECTION 6: SHELF PLACEMENT & STORE LAYOUT DESIGN

Optimizing the physical location of products increases cross-selling and overall basket value. We follow data-driven merchandising rules:

6.1 Product Co-occurrence Rules: Data indicates certain products are frequently purchased in pairs (e.g. Cooking Oil + Tea, Detergent + Dishwash Bar). Merchandisers must place these corresponding items in adjacent aisles or create a unified display endcap. For example, Lipton Tea boxes should be displayed on the endcap of Aisle 4, directly facing the Dalda Cooking Oil shelves.

6.2 Eye-Level Placement Rule: High-margin house brands and bestseller items (such as Dalda Cooking Oil 5L) must be placed on middle shelves (between 4 to 5 feet from the ground), which is direct eye-level for the average adult customer. Lower-margin bulk items must be placed on the bottom shelf.

6.3 Impulse Buying Zone: The checkout counter area (Aisle 10) is designated for high-margin impulse items, including chocolates, gum, and travel-sized hand sanitizers. No pantry staples are allowed in the checkout lanes.

SECTION 7: CUSTOMER LOYALTY & REWARD MATRIX

Our customer loyalty program operates in tiers based on monthly spending registered under the customer's phone number (CustomerLoyaltyId):

7.1 Loyalty Member Tiers: 1. Silver Tier: Spending up to 10,000 PKR/month. Earns 1 point per 100 PKR spent. 2. Gold Tier: Spending between 10,001 and 25,000 PKR/month. Earns 2 points per 100 PKR spent. 3. Platinum Tier: Spending above 25,000 PKR/month. Earns 3.5 points per 100 PKR spent.

7.2 Reward Redemptions: Points can be redeemed at checkout to pay for purchases at a conversion rate of 1 point = 1 PKR. To encourage loyalty redemption, the system automatically prints a 10% coupon for the customer's most purchased category whenever they cross 500 accumulated points.

SECTION 8: Operational Hygiene & Safety Standards

Supermarket hygiene is critical for food safety and brand image. The store manager must ensure these daily cleaning protocols are followed:

8.1 Cold Chain Temperature Control: The dairy chillers (Aisle 1) must be maintained at a constant temperature between 2°C to 4°C. Ice cream freezers must be kept at -18°C or lower. Any temperature deviation lasting more than 30 minutes must be reported immediately to prevent bacterial growth and stock spoilage.

8.2 Spillage Cleanup Protocol: In the event of a spillage (e.g. broken bottle of cooking oil or liquid detergent), cashiers must immediately notify janitorial staff. A yellow slip-hazard sign must be placed at both ends of the affected aisle within 2 minutes. Failure to mark a wet floor will result in immediate warning slips for the duty floor supervisor.

SECTION 9: COMPLIANCE AUDITS & AI ENGINE REPORTING

To automate supermarket operations, we leverage the RetailMind AI Operations Engine. Managers must upload weekly POS logs and Inventory stock counts:

9.1 Audit Report Frequency: Every Sunday night, the store manager must run the RetailMind AI Diagnostic Scan. The scan outputs SWOT matrices, pricing deviations, expiry warnings, and auto-drafts supplier purchase orders. Any compliance violations flagged by the AI (such as below-cost sales or expired stock) must be investigated and resolved prior to Monday morning store opening.

9.2 Manual Override Audits: The AI Engine flags price discrepancies where checkout prices differ from official inventory rates. A monthly audit report summarizing all price discrepancies and unauthorized cashier discounts must be submitted to the corporate finance office.

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